

Of course, you could use the classic `rm -rf /`. The Avada Kedavra command!

Back to the stable: The Push Button Installer

That's our package manager. It's called PBI, and it stands for Push-Button Installer. There's no automated download-and-install system here, it's all a-la Mac. In Macs, you download a DMG file. Here, you download a PBI file. The PBI file is self-contained, has all the dependencies packed in, and installs to its own prefix, under the `/Programs` directory. Double click the PBI file, and after entering the root password, the first of the installer screens appear.

Here I needed to install *Last.fm*'s Qt4 radio app. To start with, I headed to www.pbidir.com. Then I clicked on *Multimedia*, and then *Last.fm*. Select *32bit* on the first page, then a mirror from the list (I use *isc.org*) on the next, and then finally click on the download link on the third page. Brew some coffee while this 14MB file is being downloaded.

After downloading is complete, double-click the file. It's nothing but 'click-next'. You'll be done in a jiffy. Menu entries will be created in Lancelot and the launcher, and an icon will appear on the desktop. We are done! Way too simple. Of course, you might need to get something other than *Last.fm*. *PBIdir* is the official PBI repo, and you'll get everything from it. The version of PC-BSD included with *LFY* is 32-bit. So always get the 32-bit version.

Well, what about that cup of coffee? Have it while you channel some instrumental music from *Last.fm* over your 7.1 channel speaker system. You deserve it.

Last thoughts

You guys know that I suffer from Distromania, and I have already left PC-BSD in search of a better operating system. But to me, PC-BSD left a deep impression for being a stable, logical and easy-to-use

operating system based on a rock solid kernel that's impossible to crash (unless you tweak your *loader.conf* or run the Avada Kedavra command). It's fast, responsive, and has a host of software available for it. Everything works out of the box, with minimal configuration, and no googling or trouble-shooting.

NVIDIA drivers are available out of the box, MP3s play, as do FLV movies. Everything looks sleek, and works together. I'll let out a little secret. I'm actually on assignment here. I was told to review Zenwalk, but I just couldn't even boot it. X refused to start with vesa drivers, broadband went haywire, LILO ruined my bootsector and basically made my life hell for the three days I struggled with it. At the end of it, I put my hands up and surrendered, and they gave me PC-BSD. PC-BSD is the exact opposite of Zenwalk. Everything works, and works harmoniously. After you install this OS, you'll love your brand new PC!



PC-BSD 7.1



Pros:

Speed, stability, ease of use, package management, proprietary hardware and software works out of the box.

Cons:

Because it's based on BSD, Linux command-line fans will have a lot of trouble. Plus, OOo 3 and Amarok 2 are not included, but are available as upgrades.

Platform: x86

Price: Free (as in beer)

Website: www.pcbbsd.org

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Boudhayan is a 14-year old student who suffers from an acute psychological disorder called Distromania. He owes his life to Larry Page and Sergei Brin. Apart from that, he enjoys both reading and writing, and when he is not playing with his Python :-), during most of his spare time he can be found listening to Fort Minor, or cooking.

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